



Discussion Guide: Pete Enns

Reimagining an Ancient God

Reflect

- Avowed skeptic Richard Dawkins once famously quipped that if you are thinking about becoming an atheist, the best book to read is the Bible. What parts of the Bible do you find difficult to reconcile with your sense of who God is?
- Pete offers several examples of how the Bible itself actively “reimagines” God based on new experiences or circumstances (Jonah, Job, the Gospels, Paul’s letters, etc.). Is this something you have noticed about the Bible before? How does it change your understanding of the nature of revelation?
- Have you ever had an experience or faced a circumstance that has prompted you to reimagine God? If so, describe the situation and how you came to understand God differently as a result.

Respond

- What do you think of the idea that God is the same yesterday, today, and forever? Is it possible to square this idea with Pete’s suggestion that reimagining what God is like here and now is at the heart of what it means to have faith?
- If Pete is right that reimagining God is “nothing less than our sacred responsibility as people of faith,” how might we go about doing it? How should we choose which aspects of our faith to preserve and which to adapt to new contexts, circumstances, and experiences?
- In Hollywood, everything from Disney movies to film noir are being reimagined for new audiences. As you think about these attempts, what features contribute to a good remake? What makes a reinvented film disappointing? How might these criteria or cautions be helpful in the task of reimagining God, stories of the Bible, or elements of faith?

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